

Lesson 1

AISATSU あいさつ

greetings

Beginner Japanese — study cards

Greeting Phrases

あいさつの言葉

Five everyday greetings. Learn these first — they open almost every conversation.

EXAMPLE

Ohayoo gozai-masu.

Good morning.

Konnichiwa.

Good day. / Hello.

Konbanwa.

Good evening.

Oyasumi nasai.

Good night.

Sayoonara.

Good bye.

Conversation (1/2) 会話

Seeko

Konnichiwa.

Hello.

Jon

Konnichiwa.

Hello.

Seeko

Hajimemashite.

How do you do?

Watashi wa Seeko desu.

I'm Seeko.

Doozo yoroshiku.

Nice to meet you.

Conversation (2/2) 会話

Jon

Hajimemashite.

Jon desu.

Doozo yoroshiku.

Anata wa Nihon-jin desu ka?

How do you do?

I'm John.

Nice to meet you.

Are you Japanese?

Seeko

Hai, Nihon-jin desu.

Jon-san wa Amerika-jin desu ka?

Yes, I'm Japanese.

Are you (John) American?

Jon

Iie, Amerika-jin de wa ari-masen.

Oosutoraria-jin desu.

No, I'm not American.

I'm Australian.

New Vocabulary 新しい単語

hajimemashite

how do you do?

Nihon-jin

Japanese person

watashi

I

ka

question marker

wa

as for

hai

yes

Seeko

Seeko (girl's name)

-san

Mr. / Mrs. / Miss / Ms.
(honorific title)

desu

am, are, is (to be)

Amerika-jin

American

doozo yoroshiku

nice to meet you

ie

no

Jon

John (man's name)

de wa ari-masen

negative form of 'desu'

anata

you

Oosutoraria-jin

Australian

Explanations

解説

Konnichiwa こんにちは

Used for 'Hello' / 'Good afternoon', and includes 'How are you'. You may say 'O-genki desu ka?' but it is not so common -- it's just a Japanese form of the English expression.

EXAMPLE

A: Konnichiwa. O-genki desu ka?

Hello. How are you?

B: Hai, genki desu.

Yes, I'm fine.

Hajimemashite はじめまして

Literally means 'I am meeting you for the first time', so it can be used for 'How do you do?'

→ *used as a greeting: "How do you do?"*

Doozo yoroshiku どうぞよろしく

Originally means 'Please do me a favour'. It's used for 'I am glad to meet you', and is often used together with 'Hajimemashite'.

EXAMPLE

Hajimemashite.

How do you do?

Doozo yoroshiku.

Nice to meet you.

-San さん

The suffix 'san' is usually put after the name, similar to 'Mr., Miss, Ms., Mrs.'. It's used after family names and also first / full names for politeness. 'San' cannot be used when talking about yourself.

EXAMPLE

Honda-san

Mr. Honda

Kazuo-san

Kazuo

Honda Kazuo-san

Mr. Kazuo Honda

Grammar

文法

Lesson 1 ・ AISATSU

Word Order (I) 語順 — 1

In Japanese, sentences end in their predicates (verbs etc.).

Watashi wa Seeko desu.

I am Seeko.

Jon-san wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

John is Australian.

The subject can often be omitted if it's already known.

A: (Anata wa) Nihon-jin desu ka?

Are (you) Japanese?

B: Hai, (watashi wa) Nihon-jin desu.

Yes, (I) am Japanese.

Word Order (I) 語順 — 2

Verbs don't change between 1st / 2nd / 3rd person, or in plurals.

EXAMPLE

Watashi wa Seeko desu.

I am Seeko.

Anata wa Amerika-jin desu ka?

Are you American?

Jon-san wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

John is Australian.

Watashi-tachi wa Nihon-jin desu.

We are Japanese.

Particle 'Wa'

Particles indicate the function of the preceding word. 'Wa' marks the topic -- the word before 'wa' often becomes the subject, translated as 'as for...', 'talking about...' etc.

EXAMPLE

Watashi wa Jon desu.

Talking about me / I am John.

Seeko-san wa Nihon-jin desu.

As for Seeko / she is Japanese.

Negative form 'de wa ari-masen'

This expression is the negative form of 'desu'.

EXAMPLE

Watashi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen. *I am not Japanese.*

Jon-san wa Amerika-jin de wa ari-masen. *John is not American.*

Particle 'Ka'

When particle 'ka' is put at the end of a sentence, it becomes a question.

EXAMPLE

Anata wa Amerika-jin desu ka?

Are you American?

Seeko-san wa Nihon-jin desu ka?

Is Seeko Japanese?

Exercises

練習問題

Exercise 1 (1) & (3) 置換練習

Substitute the underlined word for each option below.

(1) Watashi wa Seeko desu. / (3) Watashi wa Seeko de wa ari-masen.

word	(1) positive	(3) negative
Jon	Watashi wa Jon desu.	Watashi wa Jon de wa ari-masen.
Nihon-jin	Watashi wa Nihon-jin desu.	Watashi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.
Amerika-jin	Watashi wa Amerika-jin desu.	Watashi wa Amerika-jin de wa ari-masen.
Oosutoraria-jin	Watashi wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.	Watashi wa Oosutoraria-jin de wa ari-masen.
Chuugoku-jin*	Watashi wa Chuugoku-jin desu.	Watashi wa Chuugoku-jin de wa ari-masen.

* Chuugoku-jin = Chinese

Exercise 1 (2) & (4) 置換練習

(2) Watashi wa Nihon-jin desu. / (4) Watashi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.

word	(2) positive	(4) negative
watashi-tachi*	watashi-tachi wa Nihon-jin desu.	watashi-tachi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.
anata	anata wa Nihon-jin desu.	anata wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.
anata-tachi*	anata-tachi wa Nihon-jin desu.	anata-tachi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.
kare*	kare wa Nihon-jin desu.	kare wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.
kanojo*	kanojo wa Nihon-jin desu.	kanojo wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.

* *watashi-tachi = we, anata-tachi = you (pl.), kare = he, kanojo = she. 'Tachi' is a plural sign for people only.*

Exercise 1 (5) + Exercise 2 置換と応答

(5) Anata wa Seeko-san desu ka?

Anata wa Jon-san desu ka?

Anata wa Nihon-jin desu ka?

Anata wa Amerika-jin desu ka?

Anata wa Oosutoraria-jin desu ka?

Anata wa Chuugoku-jin desu ka?

EXERCISE 2 — ANSWER

BOTH WAYS

Anata wa Seeko-san desu ka?

P. Hai, Seeko desu.

N. Iie, Seeko de wa ari-masen.

Exercise 3

繰り返し練習

Repeat the following sentences after the teacher (don't look at the textbook).

(1) Watashi wa Nihon-jin desu.

(6) Kanojo wa Seeko-san desu.

(2) Seeko-san wa Amerika-jin de wa ari-masen.

(7) Kare wa Amerika-jin de wa ari-masen.

(3) Jon-san wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

(8) Anata wa Oosutoraria-jin desu ka?

(4) Anata-tachi wa Chuugoku-jin desu ka?

(9) Watashi wa Chuugoku-jin de wa ari-masen.

(5) Watashi-tachi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.

(10) Kazuo-san wa Nihon-jin desu ka?

Exercise 4 (1) パターン練習

Anata wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

SUBJECT SUBSTITUTIONS

Jon-san wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

Seeko-san wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

watashi-tachi wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

anata-tachi wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.

COMPLEMENT SUBSTITUTIONS

Anata wa Amerika-jin desu.

Anata wa Nihon-jin desu.

Anata wa Chuugoku-jin desu.

Chain further substitutions as your teacher directs.

Exercise 4 (2) パターン練習

Anata wa Amerika-jin desu ka?

SUBJECT SUBSTITUTIONS

**anata-tachi wa Amerika-jin
desu ka?**

**Seeko-san wa Amerika-jin desu
ka?**

**Jon-san wa Amerika-jin desu
ka?**

COMPLEMENT SUBSTITUTIONS

Anata wa Nihon-jin desu ka?

**Anata wa Chuugoku-jin desu
ka?**

**Anata wa Oosutoraria-jin desu
ka?**

Chain further substitutions as your teacher directs.

Exercise 4 (3) パターン練習

Watashi wa Chuugoku-jin de wa ari-masen.

SUBJECT SUBSTITUTIONS

**watashi-tachi wa Chuugoku-jin
de wa ari-masen.**

**kare wa Chuugoku-jin de wa
ari-masen.**

**kanojo wa Chuugoku-jin de wa
ari-masen.**

COMPLEMENT SUBSTITUTIONS

**Watashi wa Oosutoraria-jin de
wa ari-masen.**

**Watashi wa Amerika-jin de wa
ari-masen.**

**Watashi wa Nihon-jin de wa
ari-masen.**

Chain further substitutions as your teacher directs.

Exercise 4 (4) パターン練習

Watashi wa Chuugoku-jin desu.

SUBJECT SUBSTITUTIONS

anata wa Chuugoku-jin desu.

Jon-san wa Chuugoku-jin desu.

**watashi-tachi wa Chuugoku-jin
desu.**

**Seeko-san wa Chuugoku-jin
desu.**

COMPLEMENT SUBSTITUTIONS

Watashi wa Amerika-jin desu.

Watashi wa Nihon-jin desu.

**Watashi wa Oosutoraria-jin
desu.**

Chain further substitutions as your teacher directs.

Exercise 5

自己紹介

Introduce yourself, substituting the opening greeting.

PATTERN

Konnichiwa.

Hajimemashite.

**Watashi wa (Seeko)
desu.**

Doozo yoroshiku.

1

Ohayoo gozai-masu.

Hajimemashite.

Watashi wa (Seeko) desu.

Doozo yoroshiku.

2

Konbanwa.

Hajimemashite.

Watashi wa (Seeko) desu.

Doozo yoroshiku.

Pronunciation Drill A 発音練習

Pronounce the following words.

1. ohayoo gozai-masu

2. konnichiwa

3. konbanwa

4. oyasumi nasai

5. sayoonara

6. watashi

7. anata

8. Jon-san

9. Seeko-san

10. Nihon-jin

Pronunciation Drill B

発音練習

Pronounce the following sentences.

1. Watashi wa Nihon-jin desu.
2. Jon-san wa Oosutoraria-jin desu.
3. Watashi wa Nihon-jin de wa ari-masen.
4. Seeko-san wa Nihon-jin desu ka?
5. Anata wa Oosutoraria-jin desu ka?

Extra Study

番外編

Numbers, months, and time

Numbers (I)

	ichi	ni	san	shi / yon	go	roku	shichi / nana	hachi	ku / kyuu
10 juu	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20 ni-juu	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30 san-juu	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39
40 yon-juu	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49
50 go-juu	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59
60 roku-juu	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69
70 nana-juu	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79
80 hachi-juu	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89
90 kyuu-juu	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99

0 : zero, ree 11 (juu-ichi) = 10 (juu) + 1 (ichi) 20 (ni-juu) = 2 (ni) x 10 (juu) 21 (ni-juu-ichi) = 2 (ni) x 10 (juu) + 1 (ichi) 100 : hyaku

Both shi and yon, shichi and nana, ku and kyuu can be used for 4, 7, 9 respectively.

Months 月

ichi-gatsu

January

shichi-gatsu

July

ni-gatsu

February

hachi-gatsu

August

san-gatsu

March

ku-gatsu

September

shi-gatsu

April

juu-gatsu

October

go-gatsu

May

juu-ichi-gatsu

November

roku-gatsu

June

juu-ni-gatsu

December

Time 時刻

ichi-ji

1 o'clock

shichi-ji

7 o'clock

ni-ji

2 o'clock

hachi-ji

8 o'clock

san-ji

3 o'clock

ku-ji

9 o'clock

yo-ji

4 o'clock

juu-ji

10 o'clock

go-ji

5 o'clock

juu-ichi-ji

11 o'clock

roku-ji

6 o'clock

juu-ni-ji

12 o'clock

Practice: Numbers 数字の練習

Say the following numbers in Japanese. e.g. 13 = juu-san

67	roku-juu-nana	88	hachi-juu-hachi	38	san-juu-hachi
25	ni-juu-go	34	san-juu-yon	49	yon-juu-kyuu
43	yon-juu-san	99	kyuu-juu-kyuu	53	go-juu-san
72	nana-juu-ni	71	nana-juu-ichi	24	ni-juu-yon
16	juu-roku	60	roku-juu	82	hachi-juu-ni
51	go-juu-ichi	85	hachi-juu-go	100	hyaku

Practice: Months 月の練習

Say the following months in Japanese. e.g. January = ichi-gatsu

April

shi-gatsu

May

go-gatsu

December

juu-ni-gatsu

August

hachi-gatsu

July

shichi-gatsu

June

roku-gatsu

February

ni-gatsu

September

ku-gatsu

November

juu-ichi-gatsu

March

san-gatsu

October

juu-gatsu

Practice: Time 時刻の練習

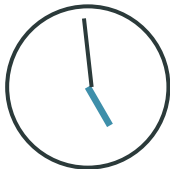
Read each clock aloud in Japanese.



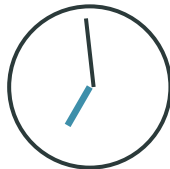
yo-ji



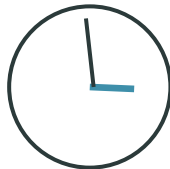
juu-ichi-ji



go-ji



shichi-ji



san-ji



ichi-ji



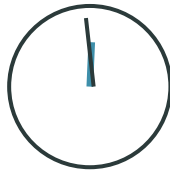
ni-ji



hachi-ji



juu-ji



juu-ni-ji

O-jigi おじぎ ・ bow

Whenever they are in a formal situation -- such as when meeting or leaving people, or saying thank you -- Japanese people bow to each other. There are different types of bows, from a deep bow to a slight bow. A deep bow shows deep respect or gratitude. Whenever you are in Japan, it is better to bow as Japanese do.

